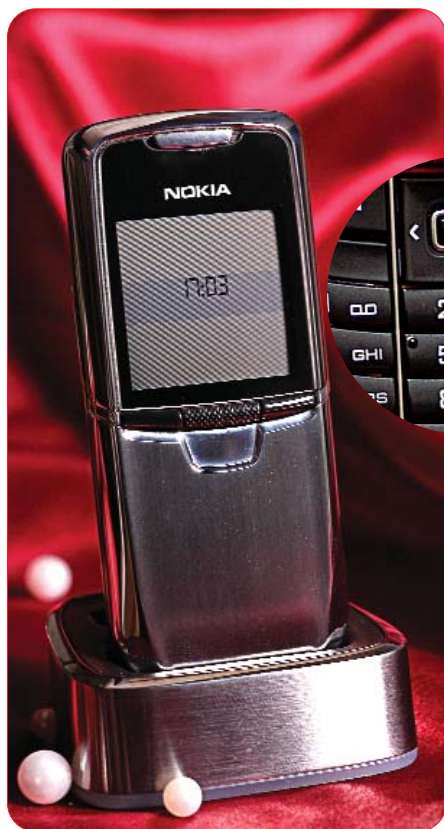


Nokia 8800



If lifestyle is all about getting noticed, then nothing beats the Nokia 8800 for the sheer attention it can get you. While using exotic materials such as Titanium and Carbon fibre is a rising trend, Nokia has resorted to good-old steel to armour the 8800. As a result, it tips the scales at 137 grams and feels heavy but still exudes an unmatched burly feel. Yes, it's a mans phone!

The 8800 has one of the best slider mechanisms we have seen on a cell phone. Sliding down the cover reveals a black-and-silver keypad, lit by a soothing white back-light.

Design apart, the 8800 is also strewn with good features! Most prominent of them is the brilliant 262K, 208 x 208 pixels, 1.7-inch colour display screen. The screen is protected by tempered sapphire glass, otherwise seen on expensive watches to avoid accidental scratches.

On the multimedia front, the 8800 is equipped with a 0.5 mp camera (hardly impressive), an FM tuner and a media player capable of

playing AAC and MP3 files. The quality of photos is strictly average, as is the audio quality.

Bluetooth, GPRS, EDGE and Tri-band support completes the connectivity options offered on the 8800.

The UI is a revamped series 40 affair—simple to use, but feels primitive for such a high-class device.

The phone comes with just 64 MB of inbuilt memory and no memory expansion options are available—beyond comprehension, when you have media player and Java 2.0 support.

The overall package is good with a steel desktop charger, an extra battery, a wired headset and a suede pouch.

Though audio quality and signal reception are as good as ever, the batteries do tend to run out quickly! With normal use, the battery barely lasts two days—so that spare battery that Nokia provides is handy!

Priced at Rs 44,000, the Nokia 8800 isn't something just anybody will buy, but no one's complaining. Considering Nokia's target audience for this phone, and its design philosophy, the 8800 achieves the desired impact with aplomb.

Motorola V3 Razr

Trendsetting designs have been the hallmark of many a Motorola cell phone, but somehow, they always fell short of critical acclaim due to shoddy implementation of great ideas. With the V3 Razr, Motorola changes that.

The V3 sports a complete metallic body. Motorola resorted to space-grade alloys for the body panels making the V3 light yet strong. Measuring 96 x 50 x 12.7 mm and weighing just 95 gm, the V3 is by far the slimmest clamshell phone we have seen. This slim design gives the V3 its 'wow' factor, and is the reason for the Razr moniker.

On the external flap, the V3 Razr has a small 4K colour screen that shows caller ID and also doubles as viewfinder for the camera when taking self-portraits. There are a few buttons on the sides for voice recording and to change profiles on the fly without opening the flap, too.

Opening the flap leads to a big 2.5-inch 256K colour screen capable of delivering crisp and vibrant pictures that are visible even in daylight. Unlike keypads on other phones with raised buttons, the keypad on V3 is

flush with the body. Getting used to the flat keys with the short travel and blue back-light takes time.

The integrated VGA camera hardly compares with the competition; but considering the slim design, no standard camera modules would fit into it! It's a good thing that they didn't completely do away with it!

Feature-wise you get Quad band support, Bluetooth, a VGA camera with 4X digital zoom, GPRS, PIM functionality, MPEG 4 video playback and Java support. A Bluetooth headset is also included with the package for hands free operation.

The Razr V3 has only 5 MB of internal memory and no option for upgrading it. Though enough for most purposes, the skimpy memory support would keep power users away from this phone.

Priced at Rs 20,000, the V3 Razr is a head turner for sure and garners attention wherever it goes. Targeted towards fashion conscious buyers, this phone will make a statement anywhere!

